

2005 followed by the launch of PlayStation 3 and Nintendo Wii almost a year later. The 7th generation was the generation of High Definition. There were some game titles supported by previous generation consoles which were rendered in high resolution, but with this generation of consoles, HD games became a standard. The PlayStation 3 could also playback HD movies and came with a Blu-ray Disc player. New game titles were developed and new game studios cropped up. The indie development scene started to gain traction too with some of them even making it big.

While Sony and Microsoft were focusing on their consoles and churning out new and better games for them, Nintendo went ahead and did something completely different which probably saved the company. The Nintendo Wii was launched a week after the PlayStation 3 and surprised everyone. The Wii didn't have any drastic updates. Infact, it seemed like an update to the GameCube hardware. What was different was its motion-sensing controller. Nintendo shifted its focus from hardcore gamers and focused on the growing number of casual gamers who were looking for something to play with their families in their living rooms. This started a trend of motion sensing controllers and both Microsoft and Sony followed suit with their Kinect and PlayStation Move motion sensing add on devices for their consoles.

Each console was a success in their own realm. Each of them had their shortcomings too.

Major Consoles

Xbox 360

Microsoft started working on its second console in the beginning of the year 2003. Before the end of the year they had announced that ATI will be building the GPU for the system and will be powered by IBM's Xenon Processors. It was also the first 7th generation console to be launched.

The console met with instant commercial and critical success. Not able to meet the demands, the device was an instant sellout in North America and Europe. Within a year, a total of 1.5 million Xbox 360s had been shipped.

Priced lower than the expensive PlayStation 3, Xbox 360 was an instant hit in most of the countries. A number of major Xbox exclusive titles were launched by major publishers including Halo and Gears of Wars. At the same time, Microsoft managed to get a number of PS3 exclusive titles on its platform including Devil May Cry 4, Tekken 6 and GTA 4.

Xbox 360 also revolutionized online gaming and services on consoles with its Xbox Live platform. Users could create their online profiles,